

Generative Artificial Intelligence

STRATEGIC INTELLIGENCE BRIEFING

Curated with Frontiers Media

Generated for James Marshall on 09 July 2023



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Executive summary



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online

Generative artificial intelligence can create new and original content by learning patterns in data, through the use of complex algorithms and methods inspired by the human brain. While it is still mostly used for text, code, images, and sound, it will likely be applied to an increasingly broad range of other purposes, including drug design, architecture, and engineering. It will also be deployed more often to create educational materials and in the workplace, though related ethical issues must be carefully considered in order to ensure its responsible use - by mitigating the bias imputed into underlying AI systems, for example, and by respecting copyrights and individual privacy. With the necessary controls in place, generative AI may have the potential to boost creativity and successfully challenge conventional thinking.

This briefing was created as part of the World Economic Forum's Top 10 Emerging Technologies Report for 2023, which lists new technologies poised to impact the world in the next three to five years, and was done in cooperation with Frontiers - a publisher of peer-reviewed, open access scientific journals.

The key issues shaping and influencing Generative Artificial Intelligence are as follows:

AI Transparency

Responsible AI helps people understand AI-related decision making

AI in Scientific Discovery

Generative AI can help move research and experimentation forward

AI and the Future of Work

How exactly will artificial intelligence impact jobs?

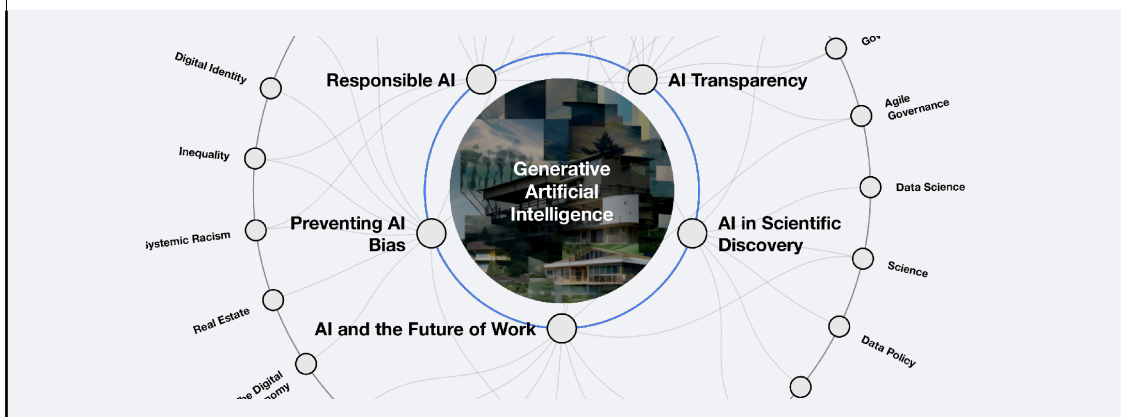
Preventing AI Bias

Focusing on diversity and inclusion can improve fairness in AI systems

Responsible AI

Ethics, transparency, diversity, and inclusion must all be considered

Below is an excerpt from the transformation map for Generative Artificial Intelligence, with key issues shown at the centre and related topics around the perimeter. You can find the full map later in this briefing.



1

Latest insights

A synthesis of the most recent expert analysis.

1.1 Emerging trends

 Please note that this section is part of our ongoing trials using experimental artificial intelligence technology to enrich our user experience and bring our members the very latest developments and trends. We'll continue to innovate and refine our efforts based on these pilots.

Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) is a rapidly emerging field of technology that has the potential to revolutionize the way we interact with the world. Generative AI is a type of AI that is capable of creating new content, such as images, videos, and text, based on existing data. This technology has the potential to revolutionize the way we interact with the world, from creating new art to automating mundane tasks.

Generative AI is being used in a variety of industries, from healthcare to entertainment. In healthcare, generative AI is being used to create personalized treatments for patients, as well as to automate mundane tasks such as data entry. In entertainment, generative AI is being used to create new art, music, and videos.

Generative AI is also being used to create new products and services. For example, generative AI is being used to create new products and services in the retail industry, such as personalized shopping experiences and automated product recommendations. In the financial services industry, generative AI is being used to create new investment strategies and automated trading systems.

The implications of generative AI are far-reaching. Generative AI has the potential to revolutionize the way we interact with the world, from creating new art to automating mundane tasks. It also has the potential to create new products and services, as well as to improve existing ones. However, it is important to note that generative AI also has the potential to be misused, and it is important to ensure that it is used responsibly.

Generative AI is an exciting and rapidly emerging field of technology that has the potential to revolutionize the way we interact with the world. It is being used in a variety of industries, from healthcare to entertainment, and has the potential to create new products and services, as well as to improve existing ones. However, it is important to ensure that generative AI is used responsibly, as it has the potential to be misused.

1.2 Current perspectives

 **Foraus**
Let's ask future decision makers for their visions of AI technologies
23 June 2023

Bringing together 25 young thinkers from a variety of academic fields, we used Policy Kitchen to develop visions for how artificial intelligence is likely to affect their futures. This four-part blog series on how novel tools will shape our lives and societies was rendered possible by the Hirschmann foundation.

On November 30, 2022 OpenAI launched a public interface to its Large Language Model (LLM) GPT-3 (Generative Pre-trained Transformer 3), commonly known as ChatGPT. The tool, capable of processing natural language requests from human end-users, immediately attracted public interest. ChatGPT can hold conversations, do research, write letters and articles and respond to user prompts with an eerie resemblance to human conversation.

 **RAND Corporation**
Advancing Trustworthy Artificial Intelligence
22 June 2023

Testimony presented before the U.S. House Committee on Science, Space, and Technology on June 22, 2023.

 **MIT Sloan Management Review**
The Impact of Generative AI on Hollywood and Entertainment | Thomas H. Davenport and Randy Bean
19 June 2023

One of the many topics involving generative AI that is receiving a lot of attention is its potential effects on Hollywood and the entertainment industry. It's an obvious concern because generative AI can create the types of outputs that the industry uses — text (in the form of stories, scripts, ad copy, and reviews), marketing campaigns, and moving and static images.

 **Oliver Wyman**
The Opportunities, Risks, and Future of Generative AI
19 June 2023

Mainstream use of generative artificial intelligence (AI) has arrived, and with it the promise of transformative potential for business.

Generative AI is increasingly part of many individuals' daily lives, speeding up personal tasks

at home, at school, and at work. Businesses and large organizations are seeing potential everywhere they look to transform complex and expensive processes and do other things that were out of practical reach until now. At the same time, although rapidly advancing, generative AI still has significant limitations in certain areas, and widespread adoption brings a host of risks. Companies need a clear understanding of the strengths and weaknesses of these tools, as well as the future opportunities and pitfalls they'll create.

 **INSEAD Knowledge**
Leveraging Generative AI for Digital Transformation
08 June 2023

From language model ChatGPT to text-to-image model Stable Diffusion, businesses are using generative AI tools for a variety of functions: be it writing marketing copy, coding or plugging gaps in medical imaging data.

Indeed, ChatGPT notched 100 million monthly active users just two months after its launch, setting the record for the fastest-growing consumer application in history. OpenAI then debuted GPT-4, which accepts image inputs and boasts enhanced processing capabilities compared to its predecessor.

While many organisations may jump on the GPT-4 bandwagon and try to reap the tremendous benefits generative AI has to offer, leaders need to understand that GPT-4 in itself does not build the organisation's digital strategy. Companies must consider whether their existing technological infrastructure can support the adoption of generative AI, how it fits into their strategy to meet their business goals and, more importantly, how it may challenge their current business model.

In addition, generative AI can expose businesses to potential risks, both internally and externally. As INSEAD Affiliate Professor of Strategy Chengyi Lin states in this podcast, firms must first understand the technology and how it can help them achieve their unique aims. They should aim to integrate generative AI into their wider digital transformation strategy, rather than incorporating it piecemeal.

Backed by years of research and teaching focused on the strategic impact of digital...

 **YiCai Global**
Beijing, Shenzhen, Shanghai Release Policies to Support AI Industry
07 June 2023

(Yicai Global) June 7 – With the rapid development of artificial general intelligence, Chinese cities

Beijing, Shanghai, and Shenzhen have released policies to support the artificial intelligence industry.

Beijing issued two AI-related policies. The first outlined 21 measures for developing computing power, data, models, scenarios, and regulations. The second aims to promote the city's core AI industries to grow at an annual rate of 10 percent to reach CNY300 billion (USD42.3 billion) by 2025 and increase the scale of related industries to exceed CNY1 trillion (USD141.2 billion).

Shanghai encouraged private capital and entities to invest in new AI infrastructures, including data and computing power, and expanded the expiration date of the policy granting subsidies to AI projects to the end of 2027, cutting the interest rates by up to 1.5 percentage points.

Shenzhen's action plans for this and next year focus on six aspects, including hiking the supply of intelligent computing power clusters, strengthening core technologies and products' innovation capabilities, raising industrial concentration, and enhancing data and talent supply.

The three cities' AI policies will accelerate the development of the digital economy thanks to technologies such as AI-generated content and reduce the application cost of AIGC, He Renlong, chief expert at the Shanghai Academy of Next Generation Information and...

 Harvard Business Review
What Roles Could Generative AI Play on Your Team?
22 June 2023

The recent advances in ChatGPT are merely the first application of new AI technologies. As such, companies and leaders need to think about the various applications outlined here and use the framework described in the article to develop applications for your own company or organization. In the process, they will discover new types of GPTs. By classifying these different GPTs in terms of potential value to businesses and the cost of developing them, applications that begin with a single human initiating or participating in the interaction (GroupGPT, CoachGPT) will probably be the easiest to build and should generate substantial business value, making them the perfect initial candidates. In contrast, applications with interactions involving multiple entities or those initiated by machines (AutoGPT, BossGPT, and ImperialGPT) may be harder to implement, with trickier ethical and legal implications.

 Boston Consulting Group
Generative AI Will Transform Health Care Sooner Than You Think
22 June 2023

Generative AI has quickly become a major factor in a number of industries, including health care. It has

the potential to transform the sector, but executives must understand how to use the technology in order to capitalize on its potential while avoiding the risks inherent in applying it to patient care. We analyzed numerous use cases across health segments, looking at both solutions already on the market and those likely to arrive soon. Our goal was to demystify generative AI and help leadership teams make sense of the options.

World Economic Forum
Top 10 Emerging Technologies of 2023 report

26 June 2023

This report, now in its 11th year, highlights the technologies set to positively impact society within the next three to five years. It provides a qualitative assessment of each technology's potential impact on people, the planet, prosperity, industry and equity.

 Science Daily
Generative AI models are encoding biases and negative stereotypes in their users
22 June 2023

In the space of a few months generative AI models, such as ChatGPT, Google's Bard and Midjourney, have been adopted by more and more people in a variety of professional and personal ways. But growing research is underlining that they are encoding biases and negative stereotypes in their users, as well as mass generating and spreading seemingly accurate but nonsensical information. Worryingly, marginalized groups are disproportionately affected by the fabrication of this nonsensical information.

 International Telecommunication Union
Standards for trustworthy technologies and a green, inclusive future for all
19 June 2023

By Tomas Lamanauskas, Deputy Secretary-General, ITU Let us start with the obvious: Never before have standards and standardization received so much attention. G7 leaders recently called for the development and adoption of technical standards to keep artificial intelligence (AI), and especially rapidly evolving, quick learning generative AI platforms, "trustworthy." The intensified global attention all makes [...]

The post Standards for trustworthy technologies and a green, inclusive future for all appeared first on ITU Hub .



STAT

Google strikes deal with Mayo Clinic to comb patient records using generative AI

07 June 2023

Google will embed its generative AI technology into computer systems at Mayo Clinic and other health systems to make it easier to search vast repositories of patient data and automate administrative tasks, the organizations said Wednesday.

The technology is designed to function like a super-charged Google search for health records, allowing hospitals to find and link information about patients to improve care and research. Google said it has configured its generative AI tools, which can be used to create conversational chatbots, to comply with the federal privacy law known as HIPAA.

The rapid-fire effort to deploy the technology comes amid increasing competition with Microsoft and other large companies vying for business from health care companies eager to use a more powerful form of AI. It remains to be seen whether the technology will produce enough benefits to justify the costs of using it.



Harvard Business Review

Should You Start a Generative AI Company?

19 June 2023

Many entrepreneurs are considering starting companies that leverage the latest generative AI technology, but they must ask themselves whether they have what it takes to compete on increasingly commoditized foundational models, or whether they should instead differentiate on an app that leverages these models.



World Economic Forum

These are the top 10 emerging technologies of 2023: Here's how they can impact the world

26 June 2023

The World Economic Forum's newly-launched 'Top 10 Emerging Technologies of 2023' report lists this year's most impactful emerging technologies.

The Top 10 list includes environmental innovations, such as sustainable aviation fuels and wearable plant sensors.

Other emerging technologies range from innovations harnessing the power of AI to reengineering molecular biology.



GovLab - Living Library

Artificial Intelligence for Emergency Response

21 June 2023

Paper by Ayan Mukhopadhyay: "Emergency response management (ERM) is a challenge faced by communities across the globe. First responders must respond to various incidents, such as fires, traffic accidents, and medical emergencies. They must respond quickly to incidents to minimize the risk to human life. Consequently, considerable attention has been devoted to studying emergency incidents and response in the last several decades. In particular, data-driven models help reduce human and financial loss and improve design codes, traffic regulations, and safety measures.



Frontiers

How convincing are AI-generated moral arguments for climate action?

06 July 2023

Mobilizing broad support for climate action is paramount for solving the climate crisis. Research suggests that people can be persuaded to support climate action when presented with certain moral arguments, but which moral arguments are most convincing across the population? With this pilot study, we aim to understand which types of moral arguments based on an extended Moral Foundation Theory are most effective at convincing people to support climate action. Additionally, we explore to what extent Generative Pre-trained Transformer 3 (GPT-3) models can be employed to generate bespoke moral statements. We find statements appealing to compassion, fairness and good ancestors are the most convincing to participants across the population, including to participants, who identify as politically right-leaning and who otherwise respond least to moral arguments. Negative statements appear to be more convincing than positive ones. Statements appealing to other moral foundations can be convincing, but only to specific social groups. GPT-3-generated statements are generally more convincing than human-generated statements, but the large language model struggles with creating novel arguments.



Boston Consulting Group

How CMOs Are Succeeding with Generative AI

15 June 2023

The reality of generative AI (GenAI) is catching up to the hype about how it could disrupt the roles of marketers and of marketing itself. Our April 2023 survey of over 200 CMOs from several sectors in eight countries in North America, Europe, and Asia revealed that CMOs around the world are optimistic and confident about GenAI's future ability to enhance productivity and create competitive advantage.

This comes as no surprise, given the promotional publicity surrounding GenAI models and the rapid proliferation of large language models (LLMs) such

as ChatGPT. No technology has ever reached 100 million users faster than ChatGPT, which crossed that threshold in just two months, far more quickly than Instagram, which needed two and a half years.



LSE Business Review

How generative AI can support inclusion

16 June 2023

Large language models (LLMs) such as ChatGPT are prone to making things up, getting the facts wrong and infringing customers' data privacy. But they also offer many benefits and domain specific LLMs are being integrated into specialised applications in different areas.



Frontiers

Generative AI for brain image computing and brain network computing: a review

13 June 2023

Recent years have witnessed a significant advancement in brain imaging techniques that offer a non-invasive approach to mapping the structure and function of the brain. Concurrently, generative artificial intelligence (AI) has experienced substantial growth, involving using existing data to create new content with a similar underlying pattern to real-world data. The integration of these two domains, generative AI in neuroimaging, presents a promising avenue for exploring various fields of brain imaging and brain network computing, particularly in the areas of extracting spatiotemporal brain features and reconstructing the topological connectivity of brain networks.

1.3 Potential scenarios

In this section, we use experimental artificial intelligence to surface a range of scenarios related to the topic. These are not predictions but are provided to anchor discussions and help you think through and anticipate potential opportunities and risks.

Please note that this section is part of our ongoing trials using experimental artificial intelligence technology to enrich our user experience and bring our members the very latest developments and trends. We'll continue to innovate and refine our efforts based on these pilots.

1. A major news outlet is found to have been using AI-generated content for years

A major news outlet is found to have been using AI-generated content for years, leading to a scandal and loss of trust in the media. The AI-generated content was so convincing that it was indistinguishable from human-generated content, and had been used to create news articles, opinion pieces, and even interviews. The incident leads to a public outcry and calls for greater transparency and accountability in the media industry.

Related topics: [AI Transparency](#), [Responsible AI](#)

3. A social media platform introduces an AI-generated chatbot feature

A social media platform introduces an AI-generated chatbot feature that can converse with users in a natural and engaging way. The feature quickly becomes popular, but concerns are raised about the potential for the technology to be used for malicious purposes, such as the creation of fake social media accounts or the spread of misinformation. The platform faces pressure to develop methods to detect and prevent the spread of such content.

Related topics: [AI Transparency](#), [Preventing AI Bias](#), [Responsible AI](#)

2. A company develops an AI system that can generate high-quality scientific research papers

A company develops an AI system that can generate high-quality scientific research papers in a fraction of the time it would take a human researcher. The system is quickly adopted by universities and research institutions around the world, leading to a surge in scientific discovery and breakthroughs. However, concerns are raised about the potential for the AI-generated research to be biased or flawed, and calls are made for greater oversight and regulation of the technology.

Related topics: [AI in Scientific Discovery](#), [Preventing AI Bias](#), [Responsible AI](#)

4. A company develops an AI system that can generate personalized fashion designs

A company develops an AI system that can generate personalized fashion designs based on a user's preferences and body type. The system quickly gains popularity, leading to a surge in demand for AI-generated fashion. However, concerns are raised about the potential for the technology to perpetuate unrealistic beauty standards and body image issues, and calls are made for greater regulation and oversight of AI-generated fashion content.

Related topics: [AI Transparency](#), [Responsible AI](#)

5. A startup develops an AI system that can generate personalized music and art

A startup develops an AI system that can generate personalized music and art based on a user's preferences and emotions. The system quickly gains popularity, leading to a surge in demand for AI-generated creative content. However, concerns are raised about the potential for the technology to replace human creativity and artistic expression, and calls are made for greater regulation and oversight of AI-generated creative content.

Related topics: [AI Transparency](#), [Responsible AI](#)

6. A major corporation announces plans to replace a significant portion of its workforce with AI-driven automation

A major corporation announces plans to replace a significant portion of its workforce with AI-driven automation. The move is expected to increase efficiency and reduce costs, but also leads to widespread job losses and economic disruption. The corporation faces backlash from workers and unions, and calls are made for greater regulation of AI-driven automation in the workplace.

Related topics: [AI and the Future of Work](#), [Responsible AI](#)

A variety of articles have been used by our artificial intelligence in order to formulate these scenarios. These acted as our "signposts" and provide clues or hints about what the future may entail. We recommend reading them for further context:

- [Will AI Replace the Front Office in Pro Sports?](#), *Harvard Business Review*
- [A troubling turn in Darfur violence, Ethiopia food aid suspension fallout, and the EU's deadly borders: The Cheat Sheet](#), *The New Humanitarian*
- [Key enforcement issues of the AI Act should lead EU trilogue debate](#), *Brookings*
- [What the GDPR can teach us about AI regulation](#), *World Economic Forum*
- [AI is a powerful tool, but it's not a replacement for human creativity](#), *World Economic Forum*

2

Strategic context

The key issues shaping Generative Artificial Intelligence.

The following key issues represent the most strategic trends shaping the topic of Generative Artificial Intelligence. These key issues are also influenced by the other topics depicted on the outer ring of the transformation map.

FIGURE 1 Transformation map for Generative Artificial Intelligence



2.1 AI Transparency

Responsible AI helps people understand AI-related decision making

Transparency is a crucial component of responsible AI. It means systems and their decision-making processes are open and intelligible to users and regulators. “Explainability” and “interpretability” are key components of AI transparency; explainability helps people understand how AI systems make their decisions, including which factors are considered and the level of confidence a system has in its own recommendations.

Explainability can be promoted by publishing information about underlying algorithms and data sources - and it is particularly important in fields like healthcare and finance, where automated decisions can significantly impact human lives. Interpretability is a broader concept - it relates to the overall ability of humans to understand how AI systems work and make decisions. Ultimately, a high level of transparency can help build human trust in AI systems, reduce system bias and error, and identify features in need of improvement.

Related topics: [Values](#), [Agile Governance](#), [Future of Media](#), [Entertainment and Sport](#), [Artificial Intelligence](#), [Fourth Industrial Revolution](#), [Internet Governance](#), [Justice and Law](#)

2.2 AI in Scientific Discovery

Generative AI can help move research and experimentation forward

Artificial intelligence has the potential to revolutionize scientific discovery. It can help scientists analyse vast amounts of data, generate new hypotheses, and even design experiments. AI can also be used to combine large datasets and identify patterns and relationships within them that might be impossible for humans to recognize. Generative AI, a type of artificial intelligence, can be used to create new data and patterns, or novel molecules with specific properties or functions which can be valuable for drug discovery or in the design of materials for energy production. Generative AI can also be used to simulate intricate biological processes such as cell signaling or disease progression. This can enable researchers to perform virtual experiments, and assess the behaviour of biological systems under specific conditions - at greatly reduced time and cost. To safeguard the validity of conclusions drawn from AI-empowered technologies, all AI-generated data must be carefully tested - to ensure that bias or error was not introduced during the training process.

Related topics: [Biotechnology](#), [Science](#), [Innovation](#), [Data Science](#), [Data Policy](#), [Artificial Intelligence](#), [Fourth Industrial Revolution](#)

2.3 AI and the Future of Work

How exactly will artificial intelligence impact jobs?

There has been a great deal of speculation and debate about the impact of artificial intelligence on the future of work - particularly in terms of the toll it will take on available jobs. Some argue it will eliminate a significant number, and will predominantly impact low-skilled workers in ways that exacerbate existing inequality. Others believe AI could create new job opportunities, by adding nuances to existing work and making it more creative. Generative AI is particularly likely to transform the workplace; its ability to create new and seemingly original content can automate tasks ranging from editorial processes to the design of scientific experiments and software coding. Companies can potentially ease the impacts of AI integration in the workplace by developing programs to support employees during a transition period - such as retraining. To increase worker trust in AI systems, diverse teams of developers and data scientists must try to create systems using fair and unbiased training data. And policy-makers at multiple levels must set ethical, fair standards for the use of AI in the workplace.

Related topics: [Science](#), [Future of Work](#), [Agile Governance](#), [Future of Media](#), [Entertainment and Sport](#), [Taxes](#), [Corporate Governance](#), [Youth Perspectives](#), [Economic Progress](#), [Justice and Law](#), [Education](#), [Skills and Learning](#)

2.4 Preventing AI Bias

Focusing on diversity and inclusion can improve fairness in AI systems

Errors or inaccuracies introduced into AI systems via the data used to train them, and the related decisions made by developers, can easily result in bias. Biased AI systems can replicate or even amplify existing human biases and social inequality, potentially worsening discrimination against typically underrepresented groups like women and people of colour. The accuracy of some facial-recognition algorithms, for example, appears to be lower for people with darker skin tones. Managing bias is especially important for generative AI systems, because bias imputed into training data can carry over into the output of these systems (whether that is text, images, or other content). Design and testing teams made up of people with varied ethnicities

and backgrounds can help foster AI systems that incorporate diverse perspectives. The data used to train AI systems should be widely representative, and specific techniques should be applied to identify and remedy potential sources of bias in both data and algorithms. In addition, there should be continual assessment of the impacts of AI systems on particular groups and individuals - particularly those who are traditionally marginalized.

Related topics: [Digital Identity](#), [The Digital Economy](#), [Values](#), [Future of Work](#), [Real Estate](#), [Inequality](#), [Social Justice](#), [Artificial Intelligence](#), [Systemic Racism](#), [Global Risks](#)

2.5 Responsible AI

Ethics, transparency, diversity, and inclusion must all be considered

Responsible artificial intelligence means developing and using AI systems that are ethical, transparent, inclusive, and unbiased. AI systems must not be designed with the intent to harm or discriminate. And transparency necessitates that the operation of that system, and the data it uses, be clearly documented and explained; this can help build trust and accountability. Meanwhile bias and inclusivity must be considered throughout the entire development process, from data collection and preparation to use. Ensuring the responsibility of generative AI systems is challenging. Careful oversight is necessary to monitor and prevent harmful or unethical content, such as deepfakes or biased text. Both governments and private organizations are constantly implementing new policies to ensure that AI systems are developed and used responsibly.

Related topics: [Future of Media, Entertainment and Sport](#), [Civic Participation](#), [Inequality](#), [Artificial Intelligence](#), [Internet Governance](#), [Gender Inequality](#), [Values](#), [Systemic Racism](#)

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About Strategic Intelligence

Our approach

In today's world, it can be difficult to keep up with the latest trends or to make sense of the countless transformations taking place. How can you decipher the potential impact of rapidly unfolding changes when you're flooded with information - some of it misleading or unreliable? How do you continuously adapt your vision and strategy within a fast-evolving global context? We need new tools to help us make better strategic decisions in an increasingly complex and uncertain environment.

This live briefing on Generative Artificial Intelligence, harnesses the World Economic Forum's [Strategic Intelligence](#) platform to bring you the very latest knowledge, data and context from our 300+ high quality knowledge sources. Its aim is to help you understand the global forces at play in relation to Generative Artificial Intelligence and make more informed decisions in the future.

Each day, our Strategic Intelligence platform aggregates, distills and synthesizes thousands of articles from around the world. We blend the best of human curation with the power of machine learning to surface high-quality content on over [two hundred global issues](#) to our one million users globally. Our hand-picked network of [content partners](#) from around the world means that we automatically exclude much of the noisy clickbait, fake news, and poor quality content that plague the Internet at large. We work with hundreds of think tanks, universities, research institutions and independent publishers in all major regions of the world to provide a truly global perspective and we are confident that our data are well positioned when it comes to the intrinsic biases inherent to open text analysis on uncensored content from the Internet. For further context on our approach, you may be interested to read [Strategic trend forecasting: anticipating the future with artificial intelligence](#) and [These Are The 3 Ways Knowledge Can Provide Strategic Advantage](#).

↓ A leading expert presenting a transformation map at our Davos Annual Meeting



Transformation maps

Our [Transformation Maps](#) are dynamic knowledge visualisations. They help users to explore and make sense of the complex and interlinked forces that are transforming economies, industries and global issues. The maps present insights written by experts along with machine-curated content. Together, this allows users to visualise and understand more than 250 topics and the connections and inter-dependencies between them, helping in turn to support more informed decision-making by leaders.

The maps harness the Forum network's collective intelligence as well as the knowledge and insights generated through our activities, communities and events. And because the Transformation Maps are interlinked, they provide a single place for users to understand each topic from multiple perspectives. Each of the maps has a feed with the latest research and analysis drawn from leading research institutions and media outlets around the world.

At the centre of each map is the topic itself. This is surrounded by its "key issues", the forces which are driving transformation in relation to the topic. Surrounding the key issues are the related topics which are also affected by them. By surfacing these connections, the map facilitates exploration of the topic and the landscape within which it sits.

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